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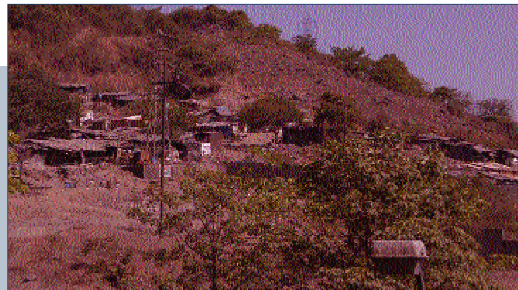


Incorrect white balance leads to incorrect colours in the left image. The image on the right shows the image using the correct white balance, and therefore the correct colours

the image will become grainy. You therefore need to maintain the correct balance between ISO and shutter speed and aperture, as well as the exposure setting.

Macro Mode

Macro mode is used for extreme close-ups. When set in Macro mode, the camera will assume that the subject is extremely close, and will adjust the settings accordingly. Most prosumer cameras today let you shoot a photograph as close as 4 cm from the subject.

Metering

The "metering" in a digicam basically scans the entire scene, calculates the amount of light and then calculates the appropriate exposure value. There are three types of metering modes.

In the automatic mode, you just select the type of metering, and the camera will calculate the rest. The various methods of metering differ from each other depending o the way the scene is scanned for the determination of the exposure value.

Matrix or Evaluative Metering

In this kind, the scene is divided into different zones (like a matrix) which are then evaluated individually for the light availability and exposure requirements. Then the algorithm, which differs from camera to camera, calculates the correct amount of exposure.

Centre-Weighted Average Metering

This is the most common metering method, and is implemented in pretty much every digital camera. In this method, the camera scans and calculates the exposure for the entire scene, but the centre of the photograph is given a higher weightage than, say, the edges.

Spot (Partial) Metering

In Spot Metering, only a small area of the whole frame is metered and the exposure of the remaining frame is ignored. This is helpful when shooting portraits or close- ups of people.

Shutter Priority

This is similar to Aperture Priority except that in this case, you can select the shutter speed and the camera will automatically select the appropriate aperture setting.

Shutter Speed

This is the duration for which the sensor of the camera receives light. If you keep the shutter speed high, the camera sensor will receive light for a lesser time, and vice-versa.

Time Lapse

Some cameras can be programmed to take multiple photographs over a specified interval of time with a set time gap between each shot. This is mostly used for photography in astronomy, or for special photos like capturing the opening of a flower bud.

White Balance

In digital cameras, white balancing is done on a per photo basis. The camera decides the white balance for each photograph by scanning the image and taking a portion of it as a reference point.

This system can easily be fooled if the image is dominated by a single colour. For example, if you are shooting a room, and there's a bulb throwing yellowish light on a white wall, the camera will assume the wall to be white and calculate everything else based on that—and would get it wrong. So, the cameras of today let you change the white balance for such circumstances. The basic available modes include Sunlight, Tungsten (A and B), Indoor, Fluorescent light and others. ■

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